Granton

LEAN STARTUP

Vanity metrics vs metrics that matter

How to tell a real signal from a nice number



01

What makes a metric vanity

It goes up and feels good but does not change a decision. Total downloads, page views and follower counts are common examples.

02

Ask what you would do differently

A useful metric points to an action. If the number moves and you would do nothing new, it is not helping you.

03

Prefer rates over totals

Totals only ever grow. Track the share of visitors who sign up and the share of customers who come back.

04

Track behaviour, not opinions

What people do beats what they say. Repeat use and payments tell you more than a survey full of good feedback.

05

Pick one number for now

Choose the single metric tied to your biggest assumption and review it weekly. Add more only when you act on it.

Pass it on

Share it with a founder who is proud of their download count.